

Robert Andy Coombs

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Education

- MFA, Photography — Yale School of Art, New Haven, CT (2020)
- BFA, Photography — Kendall College of Art and Design, Grand Rapids, MI (2013)

Teaching & Academic Appointments

- Lecturer, Photography — University of Miami, Coral Gables, FL (2021–2024)
- Lecturer, Photography — Yale School of Art, New Haven, CT (2020)

Solo Exhibitions

- 2024 – Robert Andy Coombs: No Content Warning, ONE Archives at the USC Libraries, Los Angeles, CA (June 14 – November 9)
- 2022 – Robert Andy Coombs: Fire Island Pines, BOFFO Artist Residency Exhibition, Fire Island Pines, NY (June 25)
- 2021 – Robert Andy Coombs: Notions of Care, Patricia & Phillip Frost Art Museum FIU, Miami, FL (August 14 – November 7)
- 2015 – The Secret Society of Disabled People, DisArt Festival, Grand Rapids, MI

Group Exhibitions

- 2025 - *Defending Ethical Integrity: the new Degenerate Art*, Torrance Art Museum, Torrance California, Curated by Torrance Art Museum in collaboration with Jenny Hager, Ty Pownall and Steven Wolkoff. (Jan 10 - Feb 21)
- 2025 – *DON'T LOOK NOW: A Defense of Free Expression, Art at a Time Like This*, New York, NY (October 10 – 25)
- 2025 – *Queer Lens: A History of Photography*, J. Paul Getty Museum, Los Angeles, CA (June 17 – September 28)
- 2025 – *Degenerate Art in the Age of DOGE*, Durden & Ray, Los Angeles, CA (March 22)
- 2024 – *Gorgeousness: A Summer Pride Show*, HeyBenrubi Gallery, New York, NY
- 2024 – *I'm Sorry, This Space Is Reserved*, Nikolaj Kunsthal, Copenhagen, Denmark
- 2024 – *BODY FREEDOM FOR EVERY(BODY)*, Traveling Exhibition
- 2023 – *Disrupt and Resist*, Mason Exhibitions, Arlington, VA
- 2023 – *Beholding Relations*, Unit London (Online)
- 2022 – *PURE JOY: 14 Disabled Visual and Performance Artists*, 1969 Gallery, New York, NY (June 30 – August 13)
- 2022 – *Variance: Making, Unmaking, and Remaking Disability*, RISD Museum, Providence, RI (February 1 – October 9)
- 2022 – *Pride Photo Foundation Outdoor Exhibition — CripFag*, Amsterdam / Traveling

- 2021 – *Reframing History / 35 Chapters*, Photo Vogue Festival (BASE Milano & Online), Milan, Italy (November 18 – 21)
- 2021 – *Refraction*, Spazju Kreattiv, Valletta, Malta (September 10 – October 24)
- 2021 – *It's Much Louder Than Before*, Anat Ebgi, Los Angeles, CA (August 14 – September 18)
- 2021 – *Hindsight 2020*, Yale School of Art Gallery, New Haven, CT
- 2019–2020 – *Touching History: Stonewall 50*, Palm Springs Art Museum, Palm Springs, CA (October 12, 2019 – March 17, 2020)
- 2016 – *ELEVATE Fashion Show: Hybrid Structures*, DisArt & SiTE:LAB, Grand Rapids, MI
- 2015 – *DisArt Festival*, Grand Rapids, MI
- 2012 – *ArtPrize 2012 — Disabilities and Sexuality*, Fountain Street Church, Grand Rapids, MI (2-D Juried Award Finalist)

Publications & Press

- Momus — Erin O'Leary, "For Pleasure and Pictures: Robert Andy Coombs, His Critics, and the Language of Ableism" (2025). [Link](#)
- Getty Publications — *Queer Lens: A History of Photography* (exhibition catalog, 2025)
- CARLA (Contemporary Art Review Los Angeles) — "Robert Andy Coombs at ONE Archives at the USC Libraries," by Philip Anderson (Issue 38, 2024)
- LAist — "Robert Andy Coombs: No Content Warning" (2024)
- LAist — "Best Things To Do This Week in LA & SoCal" (includes your ONE show, June 2024)
- ONE Archives at the USC Libraries — "Robert Andy Coombs: No Content Warning" (curatorial text, 2024)
- ONE Archives — "Opening Reception: Robert Andy Coombs" (program page, 2024)
- Campus Reform — "USC features erotic LGBT exhibit by 'queer and disabled photographer'" (news write-up, 2024)
- NYC Tourism — "Pride Diary: Robert Andy Coombs" (feature by Adam Eli, 2023)
- MeCreates — "Celebrating Pride: Photography from the LGBTQ+ Community" (2023 spotlight including your work)
- Miami New Times — "CripFag: Robert Andy Coombs Photographs the Intersection of Disability, Queerness, and Sex" (2022)
- RISD Museum, *Manual* Issue 17: "Double Take: Robert Andy Coombs" (2022)
- 1969 Gallery — "Pure Joy" press release (2022)
- Vogue / Photo Vogue Festival — "Reframing History: The Disabled Body" (2021)
- Vogue / Photo Vogue — "Reframing History • Photo Vogue Festival 2021" (2021)
- Cultured Magazine — "Photographer Robert Andy Coombs Captures the Lust of Life" (2021)
- ArtDaily — "Frost Art Museum FIU opens the first solo museum exhibition of photographer Robert Andy Coombs" (2021)
- World Red Eye — "Frost Art Museum FIU Exhibition Celebration with Artists Pepe Mar & Robert Andy Coombs" (2021)
- Pride Source / Between The Lines — "Making Care Sexy: Michigan Native Documents Intersection of Sexuality and Disability" (2021)
- Talk Art (podcast) — "Robert Andy Coombs" (Season 8, Ep. 10; interview, 2021)
- Frost Art Museum — "A Conversation with Robert Andy Coombs" (program page, 2021)
- Frost Art Museum — "Exhibition Celebration" program page (2021)
- Frost Art Museum — "Robert Andy Coombs: Notions of Care" (curatorial exhibition page, 2021)
- University of Zurich — "Künstlergespräch mit Robert Andy Coombs" (artist talk listing, 2021)
- Vulture / New York Magazine — Jerry Saltz essay "Pleasure, Helplessness, Fear, and Taboo" (2020)
- Palm Springs Art Museum — "Touching History: Stonewall 50" (exhibition page listing, 2019–2020)

- Popular Publicity — “Palm Springs Art Museum ‘Touching History: Stonewall 50’... features Robert Andy Coombs” (2019 press release)
- NBC Palm Springs — “Palm Springs Art Museum Helps Kick Off Pride Weekend” (news item referencing *Touching History*, 2019)
- The Rapidian — “Hard Femme brings new dimension to gender issues” (2018 review/exhibition coverage)
- The Rapidian — “SiTE:LAB collaborates with DisArt on ArtPrize entry ‘Hybrid Structures’” (2016)
- Associated Press / Washington Times — “Grand Rapids festival spotlights artists with disabilities” (2015)
- The Rapidian — “Photographer focuses on empowered disability presence during DisArt Festival” (2015)
- Revisions of Grandeur — “Grand Edits Update: *The Fabulous Robert Andy Coombs*” (2015)
- Revisions of Grandeur — “Grand Edits with Bob Coombs: Revising Life as a Quadriplegic” (2015)
- The Rapidian — “Hard Femme art exhibit to examine gender issues” (2013)
- Hyperallergic — “Slimming Down the Short Lists: A Look at 10 ArtPrize Finalists” (2012)
- Big Rapids News — “Kendall makes long-term commitment to ArtPrize” (2012)
- Samantha Macy blog — “Robert Coombs” (short interview, 2012)

Lectures, Artist Talks & Public Programs

- 2025 — University of Pennsylvania — Guest Lecture
- 2024 — Yale School of Art — Visiting Artist Lecture (*Belonging at Yale Series*)
- 2024 — UCLA — Guest Artist Lecture
- 2024 — ONE Archives, Los Angeles — Opening Talk for *No Content Warning* (in conversation with Dr. Cyle Metzger)
- 2023 — Yale School of Art — Visiting Artist Lecture
- 2023 — Otis College of Art and Design — Artist Talk
- 2022 — UCLA — Guest Artist Lecture
- 2022 — University of Miami — Public Lecture
- 2022 — BOFFO Fire Island Residency — “Monday Talks: Robert Andy Coombs”
- 2022 — RISD Museum — “Six Photographers on Care” Roundtable
- 2021 — Otis College of Art and Design — Artist Talk
- 2021 — University of Zurich — *Künstlergespräch* / Artist Talk
- 2021 — Frost Art Museum FIU — *Notions of Care* Exhibition Conversations (Oct 9 & 27)
- 2021 — Photo Vogue Festival, Milan — Panel: “*The Disabled Body—Romance, Intimacy, Sex, and Isolation*”
- 2020 — Yale School of Art — Visiting Artist Lecture
- 2020 — Harvard University — Artist Talk
- 2019 — Yale School of Art — Visiting Artist Lecture
- 2015 — DisArt Festival, Grand Rapids — Gallery Talk: *The Secret Society of Disabled People*

Collections

- RISD Museum, Providence, RI
- ONE Archives at the USC Libraries, Los Angeles, CA
- Museum of Disability History at The Viscardi Center
- Tom of Finland Foundation